WELCOME TO
LAKEWOOD VILLAGE
SUNNYVALE
Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

THE L.V.N.A.
VILLAGER

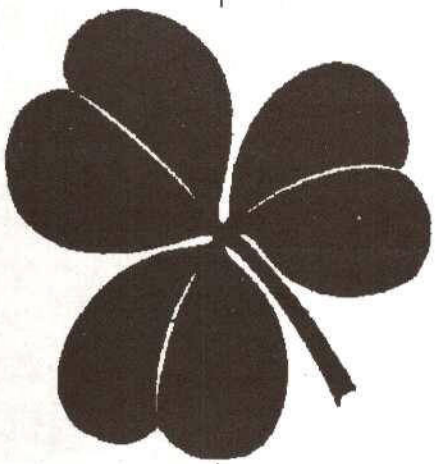
Circulation 1700

March 1996

The Patient Protection Act of 1996

Bev Woidyla, RN

The California Nurse's Association and Harvey Rosenfield (prop 103 auto initiative) are co-sponsoring a ballot initiative, "The Patient Protection Act of 1996." Why are the registered nurses taking such a stand against the very health care industry they employ? Our license to practice mandates that the registered nurse be patient advocates. As direct care providers, we feel that patient safety and quality of health care is being threatened by managed care as practiced by the giant HMOs and insurance companies. In order to protect the rights of every patient and the health of our community, we are asking you to help stop abuses in our health care system. We wish to get your signature on the petition to put this measure on the 1996 November ballot so that every voter can decide what quality of care they want the families to be provided with. We will be collecting signatures for this petition at various times and locations in the Lakewood area. Please come forward to sign the petition to help put a stop to abuses of the health care system. For more information call Warren Mar (California Nurse's Association office) at (408) 243-3391. Thank you. ☙



Next L.V.N.A. Meeting

All residents of Lakewood Village are encouraged and invited to attend these meetings. You will meet your neighbors, learn about upcoming events of special interest to our community, have a chance to voice your concerns and opinions; and help work towards a better neighborhood. Children are welcome.

Date	Wednesday, March 13th, 1996
Time:	7:00 PM
Location:	Lakewood Park Building at Lakechime and Silverlake.
Agenda:	1. Elections of New Board Members 2. Where do we go from here?

Dare To Care Conference

Nancy Newkirk

Are things really as bad as you think in our public schools? Learn the facts! Lakewood Village Neighbors are invited to attend the second annual Dare to Care Conference, sponsored by the Sunnyvale Elementary School District's Board of Education. Dr. Michael Kirst, our keynote speaker, will discuss California's perception of public education based on a recent survey and its implications for our local schools. Workshops will allow you to explore issues such as Empowering Parents for School Leadership, the Differences between U.S. and Latin American School Systems, and What's New in Math, Technology, and Business Involvement in Education State Assemblyman Jim Cunneen, our closing speaker, will give an educational update from his perspective in Sacramento and share how an individual can be heard and make a difference.

This March 30th educational conference will be held at Bishop Elementary School on 450 Sunnyvale Avenue from 8:30 am to 3:30 pm. The cost for this conference is $20 per participant which includes breakfast pastries, box lunch, and child care for children ages three thru twelve years. For further information, please call (408) 733-5527. Show you care about our children, our schools, and our future. We Dare You! ☙

When the mouth stumbles, it is worse than the foot.
West African proverb

Officers of the L.V.N.A.

President	Craig Crawford	736-7371
1st Vice President	Violette Pavatea	749-9758
2nd Vice President	Phyllis Fowler	747-1454
Secretary	Ana Maria Ortega	745-6028
Treasurer	Elena Anderson	745-6028
Newsletter Editor	Geoff Carter	733-0502
Ad Coordinator	Mel Anderson	745-6028

A Neighbor's Concern...

Slow Down

Names Omitted for Fear of Retribution

To all concerned Lakewood Village residents. I would like to address the problem of speeding vehicles on our streets. We often take walks and jog around the area and lately there seems to be an increase in speeding vehicles. Residential streets have a 25 MPH speed and not, as some seem to think, 40 MPH. We have been Lakewood Village residents for a few years and like the positive changes we have seen lately, i.e., neighborhood homes looking better, the new Fairwood Park, etc.

Our concern is for the **children** and pets in the area. While playing, they may run into the street after a ball. Serious injury, if not death, would be a tragedy hard to bear. We have spoken to the Sunnyvale Department of Public Safety on several occasions and asked them to increase patrols in the area, but so far they have failed to do so.

There is no reason for anyone to drive over 25 MPH on residential streets, especially when there are schools and parks in the area, with many small children playing. What will it take to slow people down? Do any of you care? If you care, call the Sunnyvale Department of Public Safety and let them know.

Local Hero Carries Torch

Taken from the *San Jose Mercury News*

Only 100 Bay Area community heroes – out of more than 1,500 nominated – were selected to carry the eternal flame of the Olympic Torch as it makes is passage through Santa Clara, San Mateo, and Alameda counties.

Congratulations to Mr. Eugene Goldsmith for being selected. (Mr. Goldsmith is more than just a little bit responsible for our neighborhood being such a nice place to live). Thank You very much Gene!



PATRICIA SAUSEDO
SUPERVISOR

198 South Murphy Ave.
Sunnyvale, CA 94086
(408) 453-1996 • (Fax) 441-1841

Create Jobs - Patricia Sausedo's Top Priority

- Brought Syntex Campus to San Jose, creating 5,000 potential jobs
- Created the San Jose Office of Economic Development and Center for International Trade and Development

She Does the work. She gets the job done

- As Chair of San Jose's Enviromental Committee, Patricia Sausedo stopped the creation of an urban land fill and was an early supporter of the city-wide recycling program
- As Councilmember in the Evergreen area, Patricia Sausedo brought seven new parks and a full-service community center to her district.

Sunnyvale Leaders Supporting Patricia Sausedo

Congresswoman Anna Eshoo
Mayor Robin Parker
Councilmember Manny Valerio
Councilmember Pat Vorreiter
Supervisor Ron Gonzales
Supervisor Dianne McKenna
County Assessor Larry Stone
Former Mayor Pat Castillo
State Senator Al Alquist
Hon. John Vasconcellos
C.J. Olsen
Robert Lawson
Jessica Lee
Ann Ciganer

Paid for by Sausedo for Supervisor

To err is human – and feels devine. — *Mae West*

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One Man's Opinion

David Clarke

I would like to extend my thanks to Linda Cheung and Gene Goldsmith for voicing what has probably been on the minds of many of us in Lakewood Village over the past few months. I, too, am dismayed, insulted, and increasingly embarrassed by the tone and content of our neighborhood newsletter. I am particularly disappointed that our Editor and President, instead of rationally addressing these concerns, have chosen not only to defend the childish and meanspirited tone of the newsletter, but have sunk to a new low by attacking the writers expressing these concerns in the most ridiculous fashion.

Geoff Carter slyly implies that if Ms Cheung were more of an adult, she wouldn't demand her neighborhood news "sugar-coated." Craig Crawford, after bragging in an earlier article of cursing out the manager of Dick's Market, accuses Mr. Goldsmith of being "brainwashed."

True enough, as Mr. Carter says, he and Mr. Crawford have succeeded in stirring up some of their neighbors. For him, this is a victory, but I disagree. How is it a victory that he and the President of the neighborhood association have created such an atmosphere that some of us find it necessary to defend our neighbors and our neighborhood from the very people chosen to represent Lakewood Village? ☙

Tea At Two

Alyce Balfour

Sunnyvale Community Services Auxiliary invites you to "*TEA AT TWO*," on Saturday, March 23rd, when Ginny Lee will present her "Teddy Bears on Parade" for your enjoyment at Plaza de Las Flores, 233 Carroll Street. The location is wheelchair accessable with parking at the former De Anza Bank building. Proceeds will benefit SCS Campership fund. Tickets are $7.50. Please R.S.V.P. by March 15th by calling 245-7492. There will be door prizes, refreshments, and boutique sales. Come help us continue to help others in our community. For membership information, call 739-1610. ☙

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Tax Season Help is Here!

Grace Chung

April 15th is almost upon us! Are you one of those, who are putting off the inevitable because the number 1040 is just a little bit scary? This year, why not let the VITA volunteers help you out so you don't have to worry about whether you came up with the right numbers.

Come to the CHINESE AMERICAN CULTURE CENTER on every Saturday from 12:00 noon to 4:00 pm from now through April 13th for free consultation and filing. VITA volunteers only ask you to bring the necessary documents that will be needed to file a return such as W2s and other records showing earnings. The Chinese American Culture Center is located at 1269 Forgewood Avenue, Sunnyvale. (Take Lawrence Expressway north, turn right onto Elko Avenue, then left on Forgewood.) ☙

Mrs. Lee's Challenge

Taken from the *Lakewood Lion*

Board member and parent, Jessica Lee, has given a challenge to Lakewood School. Every class that can reach 90% regular attendance during this grading period will receive an ice cream party. Help your child come to school regularly and on time. Thanks Jessica! ☙

Sunnyvale Schools Need Renovation

Linda Kilian

The Sunnyvale School District needs millions of dollars to renovate its schools. We're not talking about glamorous changes either. We're talking about new roofs, wiring, plumbing, dry rot, termite damage, bathroom tile, and the like.

After a year of visiting school sites, talking with administrators, and surveying the community, the Board of Education of the Sunnyvale Elementary School District placed a bond measure on the June 4th ballot. This was a difficult decision, because passing a bond measure is not easy. To win, a two-thirds majority of voters must vote in favor of the measure. One "no" vote cancels out two "yes" votes.

If passed, the bond would raise $34 million. All of this money would be spent locally on our schools. None of the money could be spent on salaries.

Lakewood School would receive up to $3.5 million to upgrade its facilities. Like most other schools in Sunnyvale, Lakewood is almost 40 years old. Time has taken its toll, and Lakewood needs a new roof, upgrades to the electrical system, repairs to rusted plumbing fixtures and pipes, a new fire alarm system, remodeled restrooms, new playground equipment, and more.

The Sunnyvale School District has been able to renovate and reopen three schools in recent years by selling a surplus school site. However, as our student population continues to grow, selling other properties is not an option. Says Sunnyvale School Superintendent Doris Wilson, "When voters understand the condition of our schools, we feel they will see this bond measure is a good thing for the schools, for the city, and for the property values of our homes."

The bond campaign organization, *Friends of Sunnyvale Schools*, is being co-chaired by Linda Kilian and Betty Verstegen. Area resident and Board member, Jessica Lee, will be organizing volunteers in the Lakewood area. If you have any questions about the bond measure or are interested in volunteering, call Friends of Sunnyvale Schools at (408) 450-1100.

It's never too late to be what you might have been.
George Elliot (Mary Ann Evans)

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Another Neighbor Speaks Out

Melissa Castrigno

After reading the February issue of the L.V.N.A. newsletter I also felt compelled to speak my opinion. I tend to agree with the L.V.N.A. President, in that I am very concerned with the quality of life for me and my family. I don't understand why some people "have a right" to live in our parks or shopping centers because they "grew up here." Since I didn't "grow up here", I don't have rights? What about the right to take my two young children to the park without frightening them with the sounds of a screaming, fowl mouthed man in the restrooms! Anyone who thinks this person is keeping undesirables out of the park should come look at the fear in my toddler's face when they see this man. I thought our parks were created for children, not vagrants.

When we walk to the shopping center, and see the "burrito lady" come out of the Lakewood Lounge or the liquor store, do you think she was buying food with the money she begs for? I doubt it. Again, my concern is for the safety and happiness of my children. I would like them to grow up in a community that fosters a secure and friendly atmosphere.

I have also spoken with some teens in the neighborhood, who say they are intimidated by these people. When they come home from school they'd rather not pass by them. Those of you who don't feel threatened by the presence of these "harmless" vagrants probably don't see the world from a child's point of view.

These "harmless" people have been turned out on our streets by politicos and medicos trying to deal with lack of funds for properly institutional care. Maybe those of you who disagree, should join forces and actually **DO SOMETHING** for these people. Create an "adopt a homeless person" campaign. Offer them a room in your home, or clothes and a shower to help them clean themselves up so they can find work. Get them a roof over their heads, (yes, even a Lakewood home!). Anything, but don't try to convince me they are welcomed by the neighborhood while they are living on our streets!

I feel attention should return to helping remove these folks from the street, and doing whatever is necessary to help them become productive in the community and to be welcomed in Lakewood Village.

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Crawford's Farewell to the Troops

Craig Crawford

On my parting note, let me say Thank You for letting me serve you as President of the L.V.N.A. Most of the residents have supported me and the causes that I have taken on for the betterment of life in Lakewood Village. If you don't agree with me, then stand up and make a change. I don't mean writing a letter to the editor... any fool can do that, and many have. What I mean is doing the foot work and the phone calls that count. You can never change the neighborhood without being active in the neighborhood. Put your neck out... It may get stepped on, but this is the chance you take when you deal with unpopular issues.

If you go by Dick's Center, you will be pleased to see that all the bum's cars used for living are gone. This has been the work of several phone calls, letters, and meetings with Public Safety and Neighborhood Preservation. The bums are still there, but not as comfortable as the were. Some of you think I have a vendetta against the bums, you guessed right. When I go to the park or to the market with my two girls and they say, "Daddy, those people scare me," that's it. They have to go. And, if you don't agree with me, then tough. My children come first. You can pity the bums, I won't.

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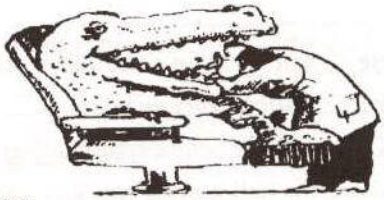
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VIEWS EXPRESSED IN THIS NEWSLETTER ARE ATTRIBUTED TO THE VARIOUS AUTHORS AND DO NOT NECESSARILY REFLECT THE VIEWS OF THE LAKEWOOD VILLAGE NEIGHBORHOOD ASSOCIATION, ITS OFFICERS, OR RESIDENTS OF THE NEIGHBORHOOD.

Newsletter Contributions

Geoff Carter, Editor

If you have a message or concern that would be of interest to our neighbors, please submit your article(s) for the April newsletter no later than Friday, March 29th. All submissions will be considered and printed as space allows. For further information, contact Geoff Carter at 733-0502.

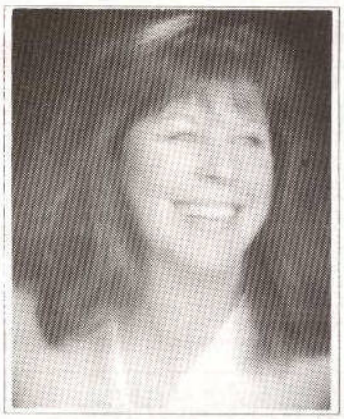
Articles of general interest to the neighborhood are wanted. They will be printed, space providing, with editing only for obvious spelling errors, grammar, (expletives cheerfully deleted) and to fit within the available space. The facts are the responsibility of the author, as are the opinions.

Thanks to those who contributed to this month's newsletter: Grace Chung, David Clarke, Bev Woidyla, Nancy Newkirk, Alyce Balfour, Linda Kilian, Melissa Castrigno, the *Lakewood Lion*, and our President, Craig Crawford. ☙

Elections - Voting - Elections

Geoff Carter, Editor

Annual election for the board of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association is being held this month. This is your chance to become involved in your community to help make it a better place to live and raise your family. If you know someone who would be willing to serve, and their name does not appear on the ballot, you may write them in. Candidates must be willing to serve, be residents of Lakewood Village, and be over 18 years of age.



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- ❑ _____

Vice President (vote for two)

- ❑ Elena Anderson
- ❑ Tom Freeman
- ❑ _____
- ❑ _____

Secretary (vote for one)

- ❑ Heather Dorrough
- ❑ _____

Treasurer (vote for one)

- ❑ Phyllis Fowler
- ❑ _____

Please do not write in candidates without first obtaining their permission.

Absentee Ballot Procedures:

1. Cut out the absentee ballot and vote.
2. Place the ballot in an envelope, one ballot per envelope.
3. Seal the envelope and print your name and address on the front of the envelope. Address the envelope to the L.V.N.A. election committee.
4. Sign and date the envelope across the seal in the back.
5. Call Craig Crawford at 736-7371 before the 12th of March and he will come and pick them up (what could be easier?) or you could drop them off at the park building the night of the elections, March 13th before 7:00 PM.
6. Unsigned envelopes, unsealed envelopes, and multiple ballots per envelopes will be disqualified and not counted.